

develop your skills, and if you try your hand at writing, you might even discover that you do have the flair. It's something like playing a musical instrument: it comes naturally with some people; for some, it's just a matter of practice before they become a pro; and some people will remain mediocre players however hard they try. We're telling you like it is!

Next up is some rather obvious advice: blog about what you're most comfortable with, what you're most passionate about, and what you know about. (These will help the cause if you're a less-than-perfect writer.) Looking at it the other way, don't create a blog on some topic just because you want to be known as a writer on that topic. It'll show at some point or the other that the topic isn't your core competency, as it were.

To belabour the point, the topic should be such that your hand moves freely along the keyboard as you think about it. Now passion and knowledge can, in certain cases, compensate for each other: people will read your blog even if it's written a dry manner *if it conveys a good deal of fresh, authentic information*. The other way, if you're really passionate about something, you can earn a readership even if your coverage is less than complete.

Don't let the idea of "letting your knowledge out" bother you. On a cynical but realistic note, it's unlikely that no-one else on the Internet knows what you know—if it's worth knowing, it probably is out there in some form or the other!

Another important point is not to fear being lost in the crowd. We've come across people who don't blog on their favourite topic because "there are too many of them out there." This shouldn't be a deterrent—it's a challenge! It's a challenge on two counts—using your writing and other skills to turn the topic into something so interesting that people will read you instead of someone else, and using your knowledge to bring out at least some gems that the others haven't touched upon.